

Brand Guidelines



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Brand positioning statement

01

Designed for future industry leaders and based in multiple locations across Europe, the Berlin School of Business and Innovation is an accessible and inclusive high-quality education provider that fosters innovation, active collaboration, and critical thinking among its diverse community of students, faculty, alumni and partners.



Our mission

02

The Berlin School of Business and Innovation empowers students to embrace an entrepreneurial mindset and leads them to success in their chosen fields by providing innovative learning methodologies and practices that are industry-relevant and career-focused.

BSBI achieves this by offering a range of undergraduate, postgraduate, and executive education programmes that are designed to equip students with the practical skills and knowledge needed to succeed.



Our values

03

Creative
Dynamic
Forward-thinking
Leadership
Entrepreneurial



Target audience

04

BSBI targets individuals who aspire to take on leadership roles in the future. They may want to start their own business or have the goal of becoming an executive-level manager of a company. Individuals may already have an established career but want to develop their skills further or they may just be starting out, in which case they will probably be studying an undergraduate programme.

The segment BSBI targets are called 'Global Strivers' or 'Future Global Innovators'. Their motivations for studying are to gain international exposure, to access employment opportunities abroad, to improve specific skills, in particular management skills, and

to become an expert in their field. Our extensive portfolio of programmes offers a range of disciplines from business and economics, IT and data analytics, health management, psychology, energy, engineering, marketing, and innovation to creative arts.



Visual Identity



Visual identity

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Primary logo

The main logo, which is used in majority of branded materials, consists of two parts: the wordmark and the marque. These two segments should be used together, in BSBI blue, or white, and kept consistent in proportion to each other. The brand logomark features Brandenburg Gate, an architectural symbol of Berlin, where the school was established.

Seen in: Print materials i.e. brochures, posters, flyers, pull-up banners. Official and/or external documents and ads.

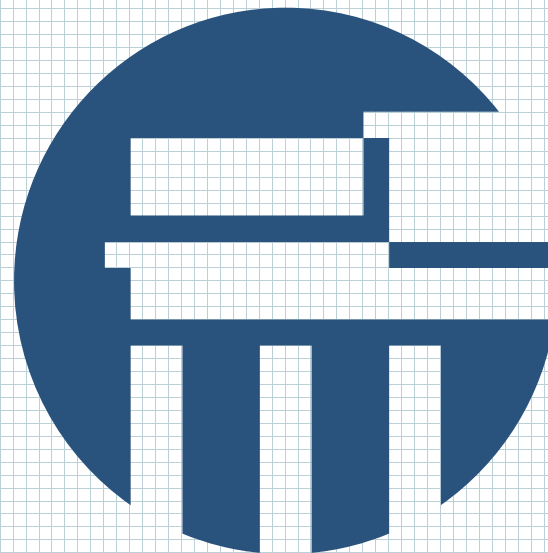
Note: In some instances, secondary logos can be used instead of the main logo.





Visual identity

05





Visual identity

06

Secondary logo

Acronym logo is designed predominantly for digital channels. This version of the logo is simplified for flexible use when scaling to smaller artwork sizes.

Acronym design is also used in BSBI's internal initiative logos, e.g. 'BSBI Conferences'. In such instances, the added text shouldn't exceed BSBI typemark in weight.

Seen in: Website, online ads, social media.





Visual identity

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Tertiary logo

Circular logo is an alternative option saved for internal use.

Seen in: Merchandise and campus signage.





Visual identity

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Exclusion area

It is necessary to allow a minimum amount of negative space around the logo, which is known as exclusion area. This ensures logo legibility and correct use of branding.

Note: Exclusion area can differ from the standard rule illustrated on the left in the following instances: profile images on social channels and smaller items of merchandise, such as lanyards or USB sticks.





Visual identity

09

Logo sizing

The logo has to be readable across all branded visuals and this includes both internal and external BSBI communications.

Standard logo height is 6mm (17px).

Larger size can be required depending on the artwork and its purpose, but when it comes to minimum height, it must be 4mm (12px) but never below that size to ensure the logo is readable.

6mm

BERLIN SCHOOL OF
BUSINESS & INNOVATION

17px

6mm



BSBI

17px

4mm

BERLIN SCHOOL OF
BUSINESS & INNOVATION

12px

4mm



BSBI

12px



Visual identity

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Logo backgrounds

All versions of the logo are used either in BSBI blue on light colour/image backgrounds (including secondary brand colours), or in white on darker colour/image backgrounds.

Similar rule applies to partner logos: these should be used in monotone BSBI blue or white depending on which colour stands out better against the background.

Note: Logo should be clearly visible. Busy backgrounds should be avoided or edited to ensure legibility where it is possible.



 **BSBI**



 **BERLIN SCHOOL OF
BUSINESS & INNOVATION**



 **BERLIN SCHOOL OF
BUSINESS & INNOVATION**



 **BSBI**



 **BERLIN SCHOOL OF
BUSINESS & INNOVATION**



 **BSBI**



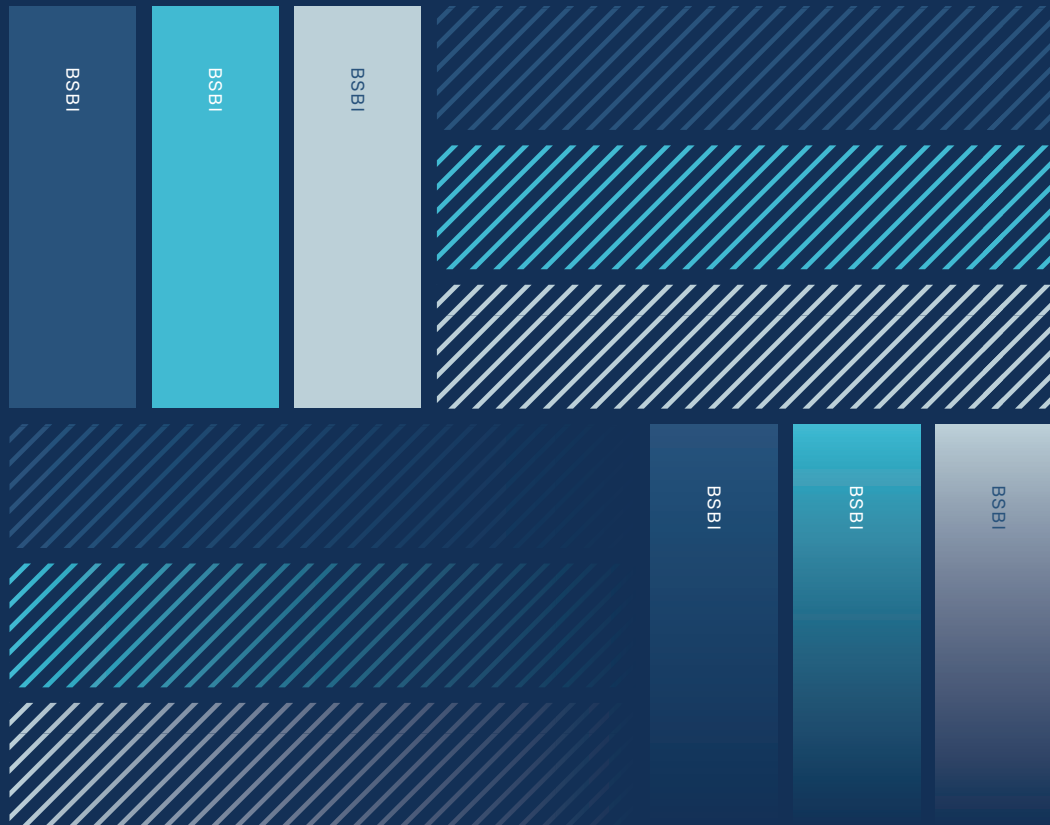
 **BERLIN SCHOOL OF
BUSINESS & INNOVATION**



 **BSBI**

Visual identity

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Graphics

Colour ribbons and patterns are our secondary brand elements. These can frame artworks, highlight straplines and headings, and colour code different faculties and initiatives.

We use a block colour vertical ribbon on the left and a supporting horizontal dashed ribbon as an optional footer. Standard width of vertical ribbon is 1/8 of artwork width for portraits and 1/8 of artwork height for landscapes. When a supporting dashed ribbon footer is used, its height should match vertical ribbon's width.

Colour gradients can be added on either type of ribbon in certain cases. These are mostly used in combination with image backgrounds.

Note: Text on vertical ribbons should be legible. Please use either white or BSBI blue colour swatch, depending on which one reads better.



Visual identity

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Basier Circle

Basier Circle Bold

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
0123456789.+*/?;

Basier Circle Semibold

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
0123456789.+*/?;

Basier Circle Medium

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
0123456789.+*/?;

Basier Circle Regular

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ
abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz
0123456789.+*/?;

Typography

Basier Circle is our main brand typeface, which comes in four weights for flexibility of use across a number of channels.

Basier Regular is a standard choice for bodytext, while Basier Medium can be used to highlight certain parts of bodytext. Basier Semibold is commonly used for headings and subheadings.

Text hyperlinks should be underlined, for example: [previous page](#).



Visual identity

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**BSBI Blue**

CMYK 90 68 28 13
RGB 45 78 122
HEX #2D4E7A

**Navy**

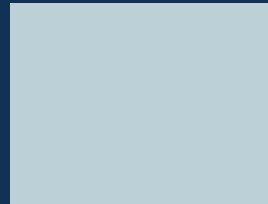
CMYK 100 84 38 32
RGB 27 48 84
HEX #1B3054

**Aqua**

CMYK 65 5 15 0
RGB 78 184 212
HEX #4EB8D4

**Light Aqua**

CMYK 52 0 14 0
RGB 133 206 228
HEX #85CEE4

**Steel Blue**

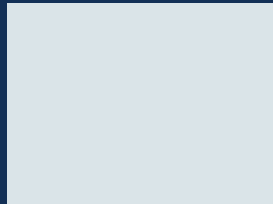
CMYK 25 10 11 0
RGB 202 216 223
HEX #CAD8DF

Primary colour palette

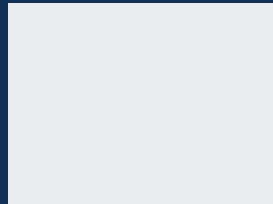
These colours play an important part in reinforcing our visual identity. BSBI Blue and Navy are core colours that are featured in most branded visuals (with some exceptions). Aqua is used as the lead colour for Faculty of Economics and Business Administration, while Steel Blue is the main colour of Faculty of Professional and Executive Education.

Visual identity

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**Mid Grey**

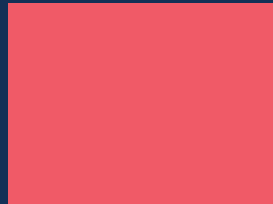
CMYK 7 3 2 2
RGB 228 233 238
HEX #E3E8EC

**Light Grey**

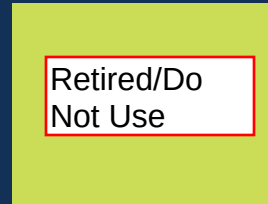
CMYK 5 2 2 0
RGB 238 241 244
HEX #EFF2F4

**Violet**

CMYK 50 50 0 0
RGB 145 133 190
HEX #9185BE

**Red**

CMYK 0 80 50 0
RGB 234 81 96
HEX #EA5160

**Lime**

CMYK 24 0 82 0
RGB 213 219 71
HEX #D5DB47

Secondary colour palette

Secondary palette is used sparingly, to complement the main BSBI colours. In faculty colour coding, Red also stands for Faculty of Creative Industries, Lime for Faculty of Computer Science and Informatics, Violet for Faculty of Online Studies.



Visual identity

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Faculties

In faculty-specific brand materials, we can use our acronym faculty logos (left). These appear in tandem with faculty-coded colours:

Aqua

Faculty of Economics and Business Administration

Lime

Faculty of Computer Science and Informatics

Red

Faculty of Creative Industries

Steel Blue

Faculty of Professional and Executive Education

Violet

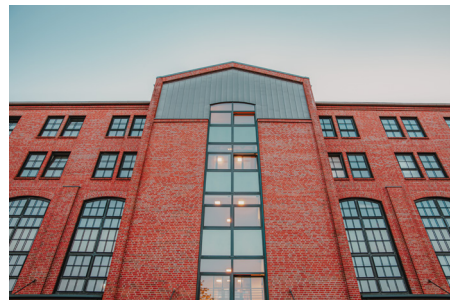
Faculty of Online Studies

Note: Faculty logos are used in either white or BSBI Blue, similarly to the main BSBI logos. Please ensure the right level of contrast so that the text is legible.



Visual identity

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Photography

We use high quality authentic imagery wherever possible: this includes students, campus premises, and location shots.

Stock photography is used in a supporting role to create a diverse and cohesive image library. Photos are selected and edited for consistency with brand colours and overall visual aesthetic.

City imagery plays an important part in showcasing different BSBI locations. Architecture and street photography, as well as city panoramas, portray a unique character of each city.

Key themes/moods: focused, curious, open-minded, inspired, connected, self-assured, creative, diverse, inclusive, authentic, supportive, forward-thinking, vibrant, energetic, determined.





Visual identity

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Why study at BSBI?



Career services



Visa information



Agents

Iconography

Icons used in brand collateral should be simple and consistent in style: outline with adjustable stroke, square corners where possible, and balanced composition. These should be used where necessary, and in reasonable quantities, to be effective.

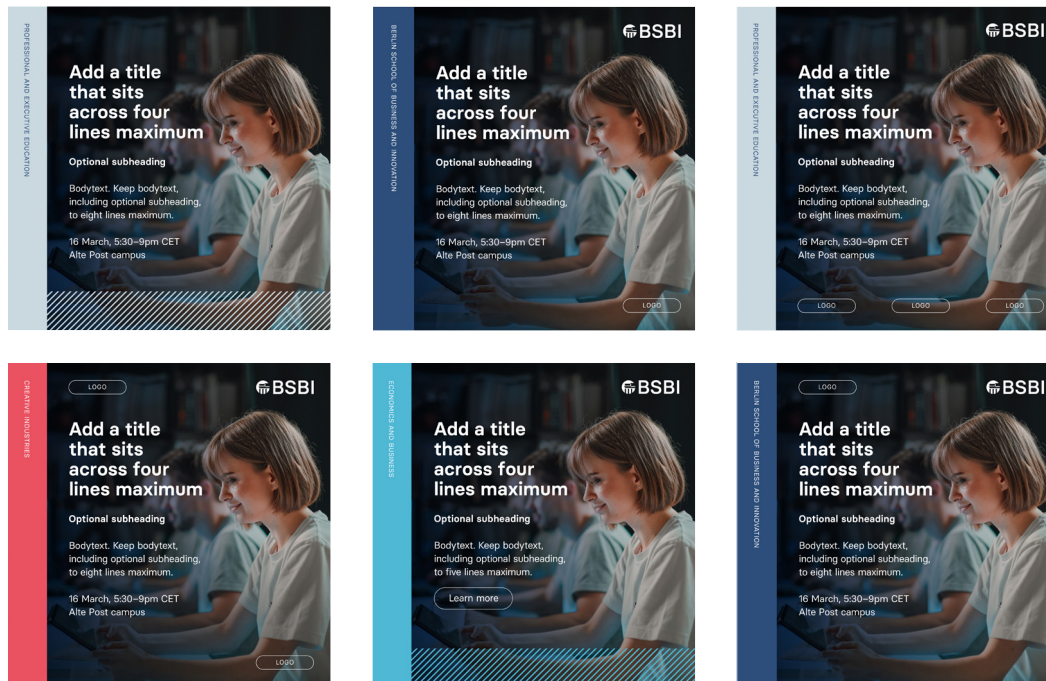
Note: Smaller stylised minimalist icons are also used in some instances, e.g. programme key facts.



Artwork Layouts

Visual identity

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Social

Social media posts (Facebook, Instagram, LinkedIn, Twitter, etc.) for different BSBI initiatives and faculties. One the left, is a standard layout, which can be resized to suit different platforms.

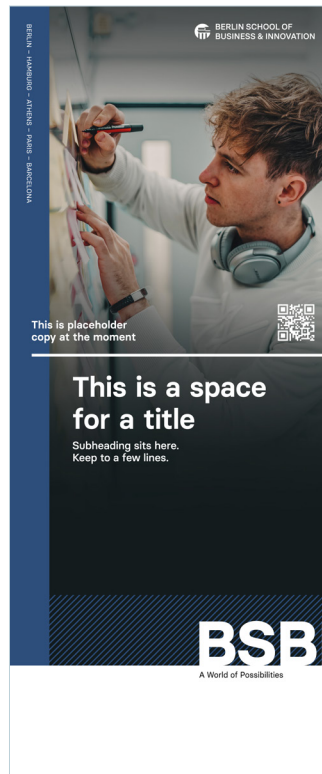
BSBI acronym should be placed in the top right corner of external posts. There is no need for the acronym if it's an internal post as the logo is already featured in the profile image thumbnail.

Wherever possible, partnership logos should sit at the bottom of the post, including academic partners. Certain commercial partner logos can be placed in the top left corner, in the same line as BSBI logo.

When partnership logos are included in the content, the dashed lines footer can be dropped to allow enough space for the logos.

Visual identity

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Print

Pull-up banners

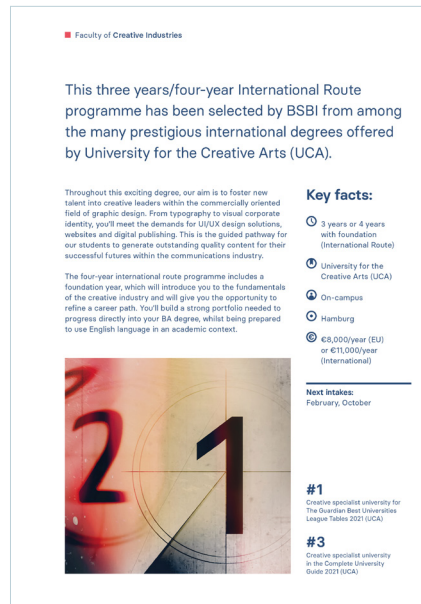
Installed at campus spaces, internal events and external fairs.

Pull-up banner templates include three variations: image-focused, typography-focused, and mixed. Template is selected based on amount of content and location of the banner.

Note: For banners placed behind a desk/table/stand, please ensure that the key message is positioned in the top half of the banner.

Visual identity

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Print

Factsheets

Programme factsheets provide comprehensive insight into each of our programmes. These are colour-coded to the faculty under which a specific programme is listed. Page layouts are consistent with our brochures and prospectuses.

Note: Partner logos should appear in the bottom right corner of the cover, in white.



Tone of Voice



Tone of Voice

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Tonal values

BSBI marketing copy should present the following characteristics:

Bold — We should always use a tone that shows confidence in our ability to provide great education which will benefit our students. We are measured, calm and quietly confident. We enable people to act on their ambitions, whether this is securing a role in a certain field or starting their own business. We can heighten the sense of action by using verbs rather than nouns such as, decide rather than decision or expect rather than expectation.

When using a call to action, be bold and engaging, rather than polite and hopeful, for example:

Joining us on 3 March for our Open Day? Fill out your details below and we'll send you information shortly.

Rather than this:

We hope you'll be joining us for our Open Day in March. We'll put more information on our website soon.

Informative — We are targeting smart, ambitious people who view themselves as future business leaders. Our copy should always be clear, informative and get to the point quickly. We don't use flowery words or phrases. Prospective students don't want to read long descriptions of how great we are, using complicated language. They want copy that is straight to the point and will clearly present what they will get out of studying with us.

Aspirational — Our target audience is filled with high-achievers who are motivated by their goals and desire for success. They see university as a stepping stone to a successful career. Copy should therefore focus on how the programme of study will help them get onto the career ladder or give them the tools they need to start their own venture.

The copy should focus on how the students can become leaders. We teach students the skills and knowledge they need to be successful in business and also teach students how to lead teams and organisations. Prospective students will be envisioning themselves as the next Bill Gates or Steve Jobs. We want to solidify the idea that studying at BSBI will help them fulfil these aspirations. We encourage students and ensure that they believe that we can get them to where they want to be in their careers.

Credible — We speak with authority on all the disciplines that we offer. Writing with this in mind will resonate with our students and give off an air of credibility. We have a strong reputation in the fields of business, innovation, and entrepreneurship, which are taught by a team of experienced faculty members who are experts in their respective fields, have strong industry connections and bring a wealth of industry knowledge to the classroom.

Students can feel confident that they will receive a high-quality education and a supportive learning environment that will help them progress in their careers and achieve their goals.

We want to convey that prospective students will feel welcome and supported when they come to study with us. We should generally focus on showing the student what we can provide that will help them progress in their careers as well as whilst they are studying.

Tone of Voice

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USPs

Multiple study locations

Berlin School of Business and Innovation's main campus is located centrally in the Neukölln district of Berlin, in the Alte Post, a historically significant building with a modern interior, set in a culturally diverse urban neighbourhood.

In the last few years, we have grown as an institution and have widened our reach by expanding into Barcelona, Athens, Hamburg and Paris. This creates an opportunity for our students to study in other parts of Europe, or to start their studies in one city and complete their programme in another, making it the perfect institution for students who want to immerse themselves in European culture and explore multiple destinations whilst studying.

Copy should reflect that that we operate in culturally diverse cities across Europe that attract entrepreneurs. When referring to Berlin, we should highlight the fact that it is as a business hub for tech start-ups. We should also try to draw attention to the career opportunities in the cities we are based in.

After finishing their programmes, BSBI students in Berlin can apply for an 18-month visa which allows them to look for work in Germany without any

limitations. If they are offered a job, then they can apply for a residence permit. We should present this in copy relating to Berlin or Hamburg. We should always emphasise what a great city it is for students, whichever city we are writing for.

Free German language lessons, support, executive education courses

As part of all programmes, BSBI offers free German language lessons. This helps to improve the student's employability and provides them with more skills to further their careers. The classes take place for three hours a week.

Following their studies, students can undertake an 18-month post-study visa which allows them to apply for work without limitations. To apply for this, students must have a good level of German, and must also attend an interview which they must pass. All programmes are taught in English.

BSBI offers free Executive Education courses to its students. The Executive Education course is made up of three five-day courses which are taken over the three years of the student's undergraduate degree programmes. Alternatively, if students study for an MBA, they will be able to take one course for five days. The courses include Strategic Management and Leadership, Thinking and Innovation, Data Analytics, Digital Marketing, Business and Financial Modelling,

Project Management, Character Development, Business Plan Formulation and Implementation, Management Consulting and Project Management.

Our copy should reflect that there are other additional ways that BSBI helps students become more employable and distinguishable in the job market, including our careers services that offer to help students to write and tailor their CVs, interview practice, career workshops and job applications.



Tone of Voice

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Diverse community

BSBI's international student body, faculty, and staff bring unique experiences and ideas, promoting cross-cultural understanding and collaboration. We are very adaptable and appeal to a broad audience of potential students from across the globe, without coming across as generic. BSBI also offers a welcoming environment and support services to ensure everyone has an equal opportunity to succeed.

Well connected

BSBI has strong industry connections and partnerships with leading organisations, providing students with valuable networking opportunities and practical learning experiences. BSBI also participates in Erasmus+, the EU programme that supports education, training, youth, and sport in Europe and is open to organisations across every level of the education sector.

BSBI is a member of several prestigious associations such as the Association to Advance Collegiate Schools of Business (AACSB) and the European Council for Business Education (ECBE), and also collaborates with global businesses and industry experts to develop innovative curricula and programmes that meet current industry demands.

Affordable fees

Currently, BSBI in Berlin and Hamburg is the cheapest private higher education institution in the market. Therefore, students will be paying the lowest and most affordable fees.

In addition, studying in Germany is also comparatively cheaper than studying in many other European countries. The cost of living also tends to be lower so BSBI should market itself as an affordable option for higher education.

BSBI also offers a variety of scholarships and discounts to students:

High Achievers Scholarship — This is for undergraduate programmes for international students, providing up to a 50% tuition fee discount. International postgraduate programme students can benefit from up to 33% off tuition fees, while EU students can get a 10% discount.

33% off Postgraduate Programmes — International students applying to study one of the postgraduate programmes in Paris, Barcelona, and Hamburg can save up to 33% on tuition fees. EU students can get a 10% discount.

International Study Experience — Students applying to start their studies in Paris, France, and finish their programme in Berlin, Germany, can save on tuition fees. This offer is effective from 1 January 2023 to 30 June 2023.

33% off tuition fees at the Faculty of Creative Industries — International students applying to study any of the programmes in Hamburg can save up to 33% on tuition fees. EU students can avail 10% discount.

Hamburg Portfolio Scholarship Competition — This competition offers students the chance to win tuition scholarships by showcasing their creativity.

Tone of Voice

21



Broad programme offering

We have now extended our offering to include creative, entrepreneurial, psychology, energy-related and engineering programmes. The institution has four faculties.

Faculty of Economics and Business Administration

The Faculty of Economics and Business is dedicated to training students to effectively navigate the challenges of the business world and strives towards transforming students into the business leaders of tomorrow, equipped with the skillset they need for a successful global career. In partnership with University for the Creative Arts (UCA), International Telematic University UNINETTUNO, and Concordia University Chicago, this faculty offers the following programmes:

- BA (Hons) Tourism and Hospitality Management (UCA)
- BA in Economics and Business Administration (UNINETTUNO)
- BSc (Hons) International Business and Management (UCA)
- BSc (Hons) Digital Marketing and Social Media (UCA)
- BSc in Psychology — Psychosocial Disciplines (UNINETTUNO)
- MA in Energy Management (UNINETTUNO)
- MA Tourism, Hospitality and Event Management (UCA)
- MA in Innovation and Entrepreneurship (CUC)
- MA in International Tourism, Hospitality and Event Management (UNINETTUNO)
- MSc Digital Marketing (UCA)
- MSc Finance and Investment (UCA)
- MSc in International Health Management (UNINETTUNO)
- MSc in Psychology — Cognitive Processes and Technologies (UNINETTUNO)
- MBA (CUC)
- Global MBA (UCA)
- Global MBA (UNINETTUNO)
- DBA Doctorate in Business Administration (UNINETTUNO)

Tone of Voice

21

Faculty of Creative Industries

The Faculty of Creative Industries offers creative arts programmes. Anticipating the demands of a digital and knowledge-based economy, the creative arts industry is in a transformative age and is becoming more valuable than ever. Modern-day artistry encompasses the ability to translate ideas to a meaningful output from visual interpretation to storytelling that automation cannot fully dictate, inspire and accomplish. In partnership with University for the Creative Arts (UCA), this faculty offers the following:

- BA (Hons) Graphic Design (UCA)
- BA (Hons) Animation (UCA)
- BA (Hons) Illustration (UCA)
- MA Visual Communication (UCA)

Faculty of Computer Science and Informatics

The Faculty of Computer Science and Informatics offers programmes addressing the skills gap currently in digital technology by partnering with UCA to provide industry-focused programmes. Digital technology is now incorporated into every aspect of today's society and business world. We are all affected by a digital revolution which is evolving to disrupt the traditional business world and bring new roles to the forefront. In partnership with the University for the Creative Arts (UCA) and International Telematic University, UNINETTUNO, this faculty offers the following programmes:

- BSc (Hons) Computer Science and Digitisation (UCA)
- MSc Data Analytics (UCA)
- MSc Information Technology Management (UCA)
- MA Logistics (UNINETTUNO)
- MSc Engineering Management (UNINETTUNO)



Faculty of Executive and Professional Education

The Faculty of Executive and Professional Education offers short courses that are designed to equip students with additional industry-relevant skills, alongside their degree course. This faculty offers short courses in the following topics:

- Data Analytics
- Digital Marketing and Social Media
- Business and Financial Modelling
- Project Management
- Character Development
- Business Plan Formulation and Implementation
- Conversational AI and Chatbot Systems
- Blockchain and Cryptocurrency: The Future of Digital Finance
- The Metaverse Revolution: Navigating the Future of Digital Realities
- AI for Business: Driving Innovation
- IoT for Business Management: Leveraging Smart Technologies to Drive Innovation
- Corporate Sustainability & Leadership
- Certificate in Ethics, Compliance and Code of Conduct



Tone of Voice

22

Language

BSBI tagline: A World of Possibilities

Hamburg's tagline: A World of Creativity

Words to use

The word *programme* should be used instead of *course*.

We should use language that is confident in BSBI's abilities to deliver on its promises. Therefore, use phrases such as *we will* and *we can*, rather than *we could* or *we should*. We want to be certain we can deliver results.

Enterprise, leadership, success — these are core principles at BSBI.

If you get stuck for ideas — think about words that you might use to describe a leader or someone in a senior position.

Adjectives such as *opportunity*, and *chance*.

Language related to taking the students on a journey through their academic career and their lives.

Use verbs over nouns where appropriate as it's more direct and engaging.

Words not to use

BSBI targets international students whose first language may not be English, so we shouldn't use complex vocabulary.

Capitalisation

Capitalisation of blogs and news titles

Capitalise the first letter of each word. Do not capitalise if it is a preposition, article or conjunction.

Capitalise — Nouns, adjectives, adverbs, verbs, pronouns, prepositions/conjunctions longer than five letters.

Don't capitalise — Articles, prepositions and conjunctions shorter than five letters. Examples: do not capitalise *a, an, the, at, by, for, in, of, on, to, up, and, as, but, or, and nor*.

Definitely don't write any titles all in caps. For example, it should be *Top Reasons for Studying in Berlin* or *Top reasons for studying in Berlin*, not *TOP REASONS FOR STUDYING IN BERLIN*.

Capitalisation of menu items

Only capitalise the first letter of the first word. For example, it should be *About us*, not *About Us*.

Capitalisation on text

Capitalise job titles, programme titles and *Open Days*. Also capitalise company names and names of professors unless the name is customarily written all in lower case (e.g. *re:publica*).

Don't capitalise *student* when it is used like *Jane Doe, student on the BA in Economics and Business Management course*.

Don't capitalise any other words than those specified above and those that are commonly capitalised (i.e. proper nouns and words at the beginning of sentences). *Industry professionals, tutors, industry-leading* and other similar words are not capitalised. For example:

Meet our tutors and programme leaders,
not *meet our tutors and Programme Leaders*.

Jane Doe, Programme Leader at BSBI,
not *Jane Doe, programme leader at BSBI*.



Tone of Voice

22

Spelling

All copy written for BSBI needs to be in UK English. The standard spelling needs to be reflected in SEO keywords as well.

General rules for UK spelling:

- Words end with *-ise* and *-isation*, not *-ize* or *-ization*
- *Programme*, not *program*
- *Centre*, not *center*
- *Labour*, *colour*, not *labor*, *color*
- *Judgement*, not *judgment*
- *Enrolment* and *enrol*, not *enrollment* and *enroll*
- *Per cent*, not *percent*
- *Practice* when it's a noun, *practise* when it's a verb

Dates and times

Correct date format: *Wednesday 13 February, Friday 1 February or 4 February.*

Incorrect date formats: *the 13th of February, 2023, 13th February 2019, 13TH February, 13th of February, February 13, 2019 or 01 February 2019.*

Don't abbreviate months and do not write *13/02/2019* or *13.02.2019*.

Correct time format: *9am, 6pm, 9am-6pm, 1-4pm, 9am to 6pm.*

Incorrect time formats: *9h, 6h, 9 am, 9 AM, 18h.*

Write *between 9am and 5pm*, not *between 9am to 5pm*.

Write *from Monday to Friday* or *between Monday and Friday*, not *from Monday-Friday*, *from Monday and Friday*, *between Monday to Friday* or *between Monday-Friday*.

This applies to images, captions, social media posts, ads, everything — the date and time formats should be the same across all copy.

Numbers

Write numbers in full from one to nine and in numerals from 10 upwards. This applies to course duration too — *one week* (not *1 week*), *one year, two years, three years* etc.

Keep consistency within a sentence, e.g. *the numbers rose from 8 to 14* (the rule applying to the higher number applies to all).

At the start of a sentence, write all numbers in full, e.g. *twenty-three students took part*.

Use a hyphen when a number above twenty is spelt out, e.g. *twenty-three*.

For course lengths, hyphens should be used in the following manner: *two-and-a-half-year course; three-year course; one-week course*. Hyphens are not used when writing *the course duration is two and a half years*, for example.

Numbers consisting of four or more figures take a comma, e.g. *1,000, 10,000*.



Tone of Voice

22

Grammar

Terminology

All copy should refer to BSBI as an institution, school or college. Do not refer to it as university. In addition, BSBI should be referred to as *it* — *BSBI has* (not *have*), *is* (not *are*), etc.

Master's — apostrophes and capitalisation

When referring to a master's course, there should always be an apostrophe e.g. *Master's in Business Administration*.

Master's should only be capitalised at the start of a sentence or when you are referring to the name of the course.

Correct: *He was going to study the Master's in Business Administration.*

Incorrect: *He was going to be awarded his Master's.*

Singular neutral pronouns

Avoid using *one*, *one's*, *his/her*, *he/she* or related terms for singular neutral pronouns. Use singular *they* instead, or address the audience directly when the context permits.

Gender inflections

Alum: gender-neutral singular word for a former student. Can be used whenever not talking about one specific person.

Alumnus: masculine singular word for a former student. Used when talking specifically about a former male student.

Alumna: feminine singular word for a former student. Used when talking specifically about a former female student.

Alumni: plural word for a mixed group of former students.

Student testimonials

These should be as close to what was originally said as possible, however, they can be edited for grammatical correctness, and clarity and to remove informal expressions, e.g. *like*, *kind of*.

Ultimately the testimonials should sound eloquent, positive and optimistic. Edit out expressions like *it's pretty good*, *it's okay*, *I don't mind it* and all similar things — we wouldn't want the institution to be described as any of these things as they sound lacklustre and dull.

Quotes and quotation marks

Always use double quotation marks ("...") at the start or end of the quoted section.

Use single quotation marks for quoted words within that section.

Place full stops and commas inside the quotation marks for a complete quoted sentence, otherwise place the full stop or comma comes outside.

Headline quotes all take single quotation marks ('...').

Use square brackets to insert information into a quote in order to make something clearer.

Use ellipses if you must miss out on a part of a direct quote for any reason.

Most direct quotes should not be altered too heavily but can be edited for clarity and succinctness.



Tone of Voice

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Hyphens

Hyphens should be used when two words are put together to form compound adjectives, e.g. *a part-time job*, *kick-off time*, *industry-leading tutors*, etc.

Use hyphens where not using one would be ambiguous, e.g. to distinguish *light-blue shirt* from *light blue shirt* or *the campus has no smoking areas* from *the campus has no-smoking areas*.

Do not use hyphens after adverbs ending in *-ly*, e.g. *a locally trained tutor*, *a hotly disputed debate*. However, hyphens are needed with short and common adverbs, e.g. *a well-answered question*, *much-loved tutor*, *ever-increasing costs*, *ill-advised move*.

Hyphens are only used when the compound modifier comes before the noun it's modifying, never after. For example, *our industry-leading tutors are here to help* does take a hyphen. However, *our tutors are industry leading* does not.

Do not use dangling hyphens, i.e. write *full and part-time employment*. This rule does not apply to prefixes, i.e. *pre-* and *post-exam*.

Hyphens aren't used in foreign-language expressions that are not normally hyphenated, e.g. *ad hoc committee*, *per diem allowance*.

The prefixes *non-*, *self-*, *quasi-* and *ex-* take a hyphen.

Punctuation

Commas should be used to separate coordinate adjectives. Coordinate adjectives are adjectives in a row that each separately modifies the noun that follows, e.g. *a practical, hands-on experience*. The comma is used because each adjective separately modifies the noun.

Oxford commas should not be used in our copy.

Exclamation marks should be used sparingly, usually to build up excitement for an upcoming event, and never more than one at the end of a sentence. Avoid using exclamation marks in blog articles.